DEEP LEARNING INDABA X Uganda

Constitution
IndabaX Uganda Artificial Intelligence Club

Article I: Name

The name of the group is the IndabaX Uganda Artificial Intelligence Club.

Article II: Purpose and Objective

Section 2.1: Purpose The purpose of the club is to serve as a place of community for discussing, learning about, and working on topics related to machine learning and artificial intelligence across disciplines which in turn will strengthen ML/AI in the community.

Section 2.2: Objectives To serve this purpose, the club will:

(1) Host meetings with activities including: discussions of current events in AI, professor talks, tutorials, and workshops.

(2) Collaborate on project work in ML and AI: members can form teams to work on projects like programming competitions and online courses outside of regular meeting times, and then share their progress with the rest of the club during regular meetings. In the semester during which the annual IndabaX Uganda Hackathon is running, the entire club collaborates on predicting/producing the winning solution.

(3) Provide guidance for students looking to pursue ML/AI in their careers. This is an especially important goal of the club, as there is no “Machine Learning Curriculum” per se at the University, despite the academic nature of the subject. The club will maintain a website page on the University website with information about campus resources related to ML/AI, including courses and research opportunities, as part of its efforts to achieve this goal.

(4) Build Capacity through our partners by the provision of free access to computing resources, research grants, certifications, free passes to workshops and conferences to members of staff and students who have shown interest Machine Learning/Artificial Intelligence.

(5) Foster scientific research, scientific writing and innovations within its members through provision of technical workshops and mentorship programs to both students and members of staff who are members of the Club.

(6) Create an AI culture in the institution by encouraging and guiding management on how best to incorporate AI courses in the curriculum.

(7) Provide free passes to Online Self-paced study courses on partner platforms like Nvidia Deep Learning Institute to members of the Club.

(8) Prepare members of the Clubs for competitions like Hackathons where they will compete with other clubs from the different universities with Uganda and the entire Deep Learning Indaba community on the continent.

Article III: Relationship

A relationship exists between the IndabaX Uganda AI Club and Deep Learning IndabaX Uganda.

Article IV: Membership

Section 4.1: General Membership Eligibility Any student, researcher, staff, or faculty member currently enrolled at, employed by, or otherwise affiliated with University is eligible for membership.

Section 4.2: Committee Eligibility Committee membership will be open to all members, subject to any special requirements a committee may propose.

Section 4.3: Executive Board Eligibility Executive Board Membership is open to any student member.

Section 4.4: Non-Discrimination Membership shall be open to all students of University, without regard to race, religion, sex, ability status, national origin, color, age, or veteran status.

Article V: Organizational Leadership Positions

Section 5.1: Executive Board The officers of the club will be President, Vice President, and Treasurer. The office of Secretary will be occupied on the condition that a member of the club chooses to stand for election to the position. These officers shall comprise the Executive Committee. All executive officers must be current or past students of that University or Community.

Section 5.2: President The president will lead all club meetings and serve as the primary point of contact between the club, the university and Deep Learning IndabaX Uganda, including maintenance of the SOURCE webpage and documents.

Section 5.3: Vice President The vice president will stand in for the president in case of absence.

Section 5.4: Secretary The secretary will keep minutes of the meetings, which will be posted in a place accessible to club members. A secretary will only serve on the Executive Board if a member stands for election to the position.

Section 5.5 Treasurer In the case of money somehow falling into the coffers of the club, the treasurer will spend or invest it according to the wishes of the club members, to be determined by a 2/3 majority vote. Any proposal that does not relate to furthering the stated goals of the club will require a unanimous vote to be approved.

The treasurer assumes the responsibilities of the secretary in the case that no secretary has been elected to the Executive Board.

Section 5.6: Advisor One or more advisors with direct supervision from the Faculty Dean and Deep Learning IndabaX Uganda shall be appointed or confirmed at the beginning of each academic year by the Executive Officers. The advisor(s) must be a full-time faculty, staff, or a full-time employee of The University. The advisor(s) will provide guidance in the selection and

completion of projects, readings, and other goals that serve the purposes of the club. The advisor(s) will attend club meetings as they are able.

Article VI: Election of Officers

Section 6.1: Election Timing Elections will be held annually during the month of December.

Section 6.2: Notice of Election Members will be notified of elections by email at least one week before the election will be held.

Section 6.3: Nomination Process Any active member of the club can nominate any member of the organization, including themselves, to any office. All nominations must be accepted by the nominee.

Section 6.4: Election Procedures In the event that only one individual accepts nomination to an executive officer position, that individual will assume the position for the next academic year. In the event that two or more individuals accept nomination for an executive officer position, the position will be put to a vote. Voting shall occur by secret ballot, distributed to each active member of the club present at the meeting. Each member may cast one and only one vote. Proxy voting is not allowed.

A simple majority vote is required to elect Executive Officers. In the event that a winner cannot be determined because two or more individuals receive the same number of votes, any individual who received less than those individuals will be removed from the list of potential candidates and a new vote will be conducted until such time as one candidate receives a simple majority.

Section 6.4: Election Certification The New Executive Officers will be immediately installed following the selection of each office. Outgoing Executive Officers are expected to assist the new officer-elect in learning about their new role and the duties and responsibilities associated with it.

Article VII: Committees

Section 7.1: Executive Committee The Executive Committee will include the officers of the IndabaX Uganda ML/AI Club. They will supervise affairs of the Club between its business meetings, make recommendations to the Club, and perform other duties as specified in this Constitution.

Section 7.2: Other Committees Standing or special committees will be appointed by the President or the Executive Committee as deemed necessary to carry on the work of the Club.

Article VIII: Removal or Vacancy of Officers/Chairpersons

Section 8.1 If, for any reason, an Executive Officer steps down or is removed from the position, the vacancy shall be filled by electing a replacement officer at the next meeting of the Club by following the applicable sections of Article VI above.

Section 8.2 In the event that the President steps down or is removed from office, the Vice President will automatically assume the role of President. At which time the Club will proceed to fill the vacancy in the role of Vice President.

Section 8.3 Executive Officers may be removed from their position before the expiration of their normal terms for failure to satisfactorily perform the duties of office, for repeated absences from meetings, or for conduct that is improper to their office.

Section 8.4 A motion to remove an Executive Officer may be made at any scheduled meeting of the club; however, a vote shall not be taken until the next scheduled meeting. In order to remove an Executive Officer, the motion must receive an affirmative three-fourths (3/4) majority vote of those members in attendance at the meeting.

Section 8.5 A motion to remove an Advisor may be made at any schedule meeting of the Club and a vote taken at that time. In order to remove the Advisor, the motion must also contain a nomination for a replacement Advisor. In order to pass, the motion must receive an affirmative vote from a simple majority (50% +1) of the members present at the meeting and the replacement advisor must accept the nomination to serve as Advisor.

Article IX: Meetings/Meet Ups

Section 9.1: Types of Meetings All-member meetings/meet ups will be held at least weekly. Meetings/meet ups will be scheduled as needed for group project work.

Section 9.2: Quorums A quorum shall be required at any meeting/meet up of the ML/AI Club in order to conduct official business. A quorum shall consist of at least twenty-five (25%) percent of active members at any business meeting/meet up and fifty (50%) percent of active members at the meeting during which elections are held.

Section 9.3: Notice Notice of each meeting/meet up shall be provided at least four (4) days before the scheduled date of the meeting. Notice shall be given by email to all members. Notice must include the date, time, and location of the meeting, as well as a description of any official business that will be considered and/or put to a vote at that meeting. Business items that do not appear in the meeting notice may be discussed but not considered or put to a vote at that meeting.

Section 9.4: Meeting Procedures The rules contained within the most recent edition of Robert's Rules of Order shall govern this club, to the discretion and better judgment of the Executive Officers, unless they are found to be inconsistent with the constitution of the club.

Section 9.5: Meeting Records The secretary will take notes and record minutes if one is elected to the Executive Board. Otherwise, the treasurer assumes this responsibility. The notes and minutes document may be augmented by all members, given that the augmentation does not misrepresent any fact or event.

Article X: Finances

Should the Club receive any funds from either the University Management or Deep Learning IndabaX Uganda, accountability for expenses must be submit to the respective funder i.e. The University financial controller or Deep Learning IndabaX Uganda.

Article XI: Constitutional Amendments

Any member may propose an amendment. The meeting during which the amendment is written will be the proposition meeting. The amendment must be ratified by a two-thirds majority vote of members present at the meeting following the proposition meeting and must be approved by Deep Learning IndabaX Uganda.

Article XII: Rules of Order

Words and phrases shall be read in context and construed according to the rules of grammar and common usage. Words and phrases that have acquired a technical or particular meaning shall be construed accordingly. In the case of ambiguity, the Club advisor(s) will recommend an interpretation. Such interpretation will be binding until such time as the constitution can be amended to clarify the ambiguity, or overturned by Deep Learning IndabaX Uganda.

Article XIII: Technical Requirements

A club should have a designated computer lab for its weekly meetings from the university management. The lab should have computers fully equipped with the necessary software to run deep learning/AI tasks.

Software's that are not freely accessible over the internet shall be provided by either University Management or Deep Learning IndabaX Uganda.

Deep Learning IndabaX Uganda through its partners and sponsors will avail online computing resources, training and any other requirements necessary to build capacity and foster AI research and Innovation within the club.

Article XIII: Bylaws

By-laws to this constitution may be added at any regular meeting of the club by two-thirds vote, provided the by-laws has been submitted in writing at the previous regular meeting and must be approved by the Faculty Dean and Deep Learning IndabaX Uganda.

Document History:

Created: _____

Amended: _____

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Signed By: _____

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